

DEEPAM



**HAPPY DEEPAVALI
AND PROSPEROUS
NEW YEAR**



**Volume 35, Deepavali Special Issue 1
November 2025**



Hindu Temple

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HAPPY DIWALI

FESTIVAL OF LIGHTS

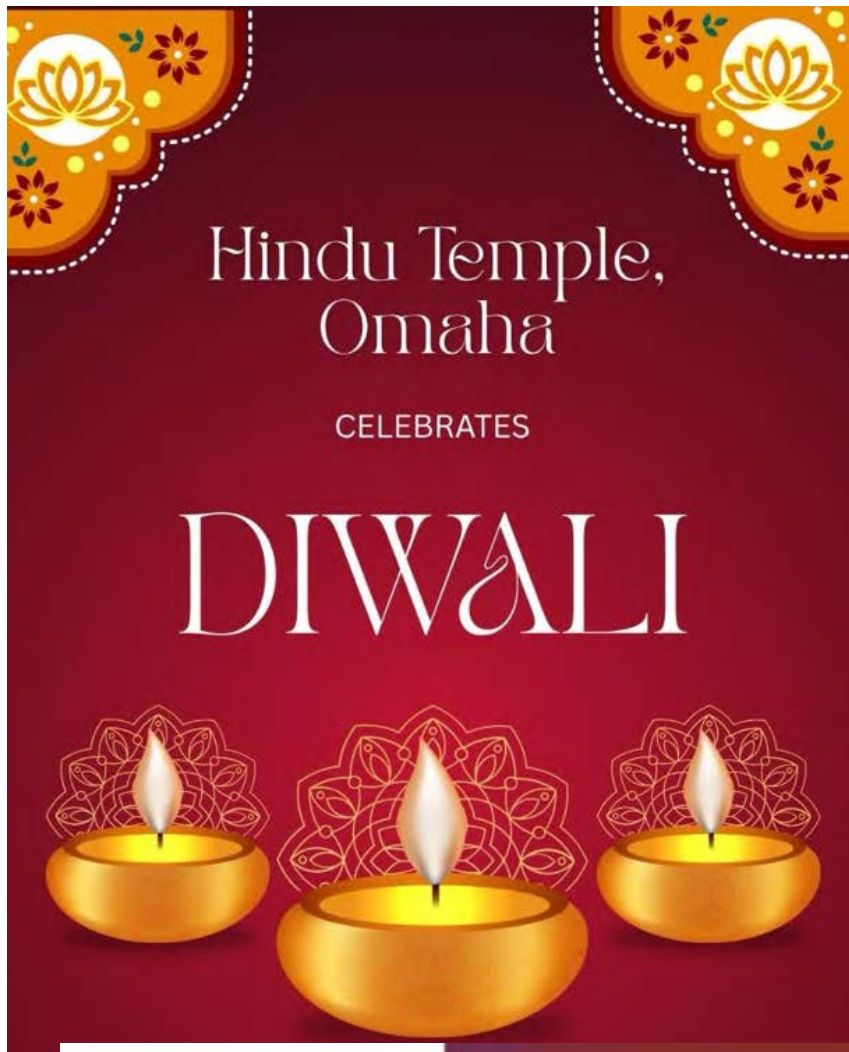


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hindu temple
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1st Prize: \$1000 in cash
2nd Prize: 65" TV (\$700)
3rd Prize: Vitamix Blender (\$350)
4th Prize: Apple AirPods (\$180)
5th Prize(3 each): \$100 Indian Grocery Gift Card
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Pandit Laxmikant (Amol) Kulkarni
Pandit Jagannatha Bhaktavatsala
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Nomination: **Srinivasa Rao Mallipudi**

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MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT

Om Gam Ganapataye Namaha!

Namaste,

Happy Diwali to you all!! Happy New Year to our gujurati friends who celebrate day after Deepavali as New year!!

I am very pleased to share with you the recent progress and upcoming opportunities for our temple. These are exciting times for our community, and I feel both honored and humbled to witness the dedication and devotion that continues to flourish around us. With your unwavering support, our temple is not only thriving but also preparing for a bright future.

Our religious services headed by our four priests continue to be four pillars of our temple's offerings. I want to take this opportunity to thank our priests for efficiently performing rituals both at temple and devotee homes to keep up devotee satisfaction. I want to take a minute to call out our new addition Jagannath Bhaktavatsala ji not only completed one year but also won heart of many temple patrons. I want to thank our facility manager who facilitates the pujas and procures material with coordination of puja committee. I want to take a minute to thank volunteer priests who step in when needed—their devotion and service ensure the spiritual needs of our community are never compromised.

From the start of the year, we have had several important celebrations - Maharudram, Ganesh Chaturthi, Jagannatha Ratha Yatra, Guru Purnima, Kuzhandhai Velan Kaavadi, SriKrishna Janmashtami, Onam, Venkateshwara Jayanthi, Navarathri and Vijaya Dasami to name a few. Even after 5 months, Maharudram stands out as a truly blissful event. The three-day gathering brought our community together in contribution, volunteering, worshipping and devotion and was a grand success. For the first time ever, volunteers ran Golf carts to transport devotees to and from the AtHome parking lot to a pleasant surprise by everyone. I thank each and every volunteer and devotee who made it happen. We also performed the Chandi Homam, a sacred ritual intended to remove negativity and promote well-being, education, career success, and peace.

Another major milestone was the renovation of the Community Center kitchen. As our devotee base grows, so does the need for improved infrastructure. This upgraded kitchen has significantly increased our capacity to prepare and serve weekend cafeteria as well as prasad for large gatherings.

From its humble beginnings in 1993, our temple has evolved into a spiritual beacon for Hindus across Nebraska and neighboring regions. With thousands of devotees visiting each month, we are committed to preserving the legacy of this sacred place. We have initiated the temple history project to document and preserve the temple's journey for future generations. This is a significant undertaking, and we are excited to share more about its progress in the coming months.

As we look ahead to Kumbabhishekam in 2027, our planning has already begun. We are building financial reserves to support the necessary temple restorations and Indianization efforts. These projects represent both a spiritual and structural renewal of our temple. I am hopeful that our community will come forward generously to help us shoulder this sacred event. Some of the major initiatives for this effort include:

- Construction of a permanent Havan kund.
- Complete replacement of the temple roofing.
- Renovation of the Rajagopuram along with traditional Indianization efforts. We are bringing in experienced Shilpis from India specially for this purpose.

Our weekend Prasadalaya, run by a dedicated team of volunteers, continues to be a popular and vital part of the temple. It not only serves delicious meals at modest prices but also fosters a strong sense of community. I want to thank all our hardworking volunteers and our loyal patrons for making this a continued success.

Additionally, I would like to make a humble appeal to all devotees regarding temple cleanliness. With such a large number of visitors each month, it's important that we all do our part to keep our sacred spaces clean. Whether it's putting things back after an event, or helping maintain clean walkways and bathrooms, every small act makes a big difference. This greatly helps those who handle cleanup duties and ensures a pleasant experience for everyone.

As I reflect on the success of recent events like Maharudram and the steps being taken toward Kumbabhishekam 2027, I am filled with gratitude and anticipation. We are embarking on a significant journey of restoration and spiritual upliftment. With your support and the blessings of the divine, I am confident that we will meet every challenge ahead.

I look forward to working with all of you in service to our temple and community. Thank you for your continued devotion and generosity.

Lokah Samastah Sukhinav Bhavantu!

Surendra Khandavalli
President, Executive Committee (2025-26)



MESSAGE FROM THE CHAIRMAN

Dear Hindu Temple Devotees,

Namaskar & Happy Deepavali!

May the divine blessings of Goddess Lakshmi and Lord Ganesh fill your homes with joy, peace, and prosperity.

As we celebrate this auspicious Festival of Lights, I feel deeply honored and grateful to share this message as Chairperson of the Board of Trustees. Our Temple stands today as a sacred space of devotion, learning, and community — a realization of the vision and dedication of our founders, whose selfless efforts built this beautiful Temple. My heartfelt gratitude to them and to all leaders, past and present, who have continuously strengthened this institution and created remarkable milestones for our community.

Recent accomplishments such as the Temple Legacy Project, the Maha Rudram, and the Prasadam Hall renovation exemplify what we can achieve together through Nishkaama Seva — selfless service offered with devotion. I sincerely thank all past Presidents and Board Chairs for their unwavering leadership and service to the Temple.



It was especially inspiring to witness the seamless transition of leadership this July, with Past President Sundar Chokkara and current President Surendra working together in full harmony. This spirit of collaboration ensures continuity in Temple operations and projects, a true reflection of unity and commitment within our community.

A special note of appreciation to the Temple Legacy Project team, led by Mrs. Ambika Nair and Dr. Meera Dewan, for their tireless work in creating a beautiful book that captures the Temple's history and significant milestones. This project will stand as a treasured record of our spiritual and cultural journey.

This year, the Board of Trustees will be focusing on several key initiatives:

- Enhancing Temple Security to ensure a safe and welcoming environment for all devotees,
- Initiating the Kumbabhishekam — the sacred 12-year re-consecration ceremony of our Temple,

Continuing bylaws additions and clarifications to strengthen governance and institutional continuity. In alignment with these initiatives:

- The Executive Committee recommended the installation of a Hanuman deity, creating an additional Hanuman Sanctum. The Board has appointed Dr. Phani Adidam to form a working team and develop a detailed project plan and estimate for the Board's review.
- The Board of Trustees has also nominated Dr. Shanta Ram Joshi to lead the Kumbabhishekam 2027, guiding the planning and coordination of this sacred event.

Rajesh Sharma and Sai Repakula are leading security project to incorporate safety measures to the temple Congregation.

All these endeavors are possible only through the Nishkaama Seva of our devotees, leaders, and volunteers. On behalf of the Board of Trustees, I extend my heartfelt gratitude to each of you for your continued dedication, contributions, and prayers.

May this Deepavali bring renewed light, love, and blessings into every home and continue to illuminate the path of our Temple's divine journey.

With Warm Regards, Gratitude, and Blessings,

Srini Nedunoori

Chairperson, Board of Trustees (2025-26)



Experience the Royal Flavors of India



TASTE THE TRADITION

At Maharaja Indian Cuisine, we bring you authentic Indian flavors with our specially crafted vegetarian menu. Each dish is a celebration of rich heritage and culinary excellence.

SAVOR THE SPICE

Indulge in a symphony of spices that dance on your palate. Our chefs use the freshest ingredients to create meals that are not only delicious but also a feast for the eyes.



HEALTHY & WHOLESOME

Our vegetarian dishes are not just about taste, but also about nutrition. Enjoy meals that are balanced, healthy, and full of flavor.

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Hindu Temple, Omaha NE (Jan 2025 - Sep 2025)

INFLOW		OUTFLOW	
Hundi Collection	\$162,253	Priest & Staff expenses	\$150,368
Private Puja Services	\$108,676	Operating Expenses	\$260,284
Direct Deposit	\$28,240	Temple Prasadam Expense	\$52,403
Other Sponsors	\$20,356	Temple Events Expenses	\$147,075
Temple Events Sponsorship	\$390,226	New Construction	\$179,574
Donations for Projects	\$9,623	Deity Jewelry	\$5,736
Temple Prasadam	\$178,654		
Temple Prasadam Sponsorship	\$20,922		
Miscellaneous	\$27,524		
Total Inflow 2025 (YTD)	\$946,474	Total outflow 2025 (YTD)	\$795,440

----- Balances As of September 2025 -----

Total Liabilities: **\$0**

Operating Account Balance: **\$255,075**

Savings (Endowment) Balance: **\$649,207**

Interested in donating your appreciated securities (stocks)? It's very easy to transfer to your Temple! Please supply the following info to your brokerage firm.

Receiving Firm Name: **Charles Schwab**

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NOTE: This is subject to change and hence please check with Temple for the latest account information.

Then, email htom.finance@gmail.com with the details about your donation and contact information and with the subject line "Securities Donation" so that we can follow up to ensure a successful transfer. We generally consider the closing price of the stock on the day we have received to value your contribution. It's that easy!!

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Deepavali greetings to all
From
Ramakrishnans
—V T, Usha, Praveen, Madan, Lauryl, Sabina, Liliana—



Balvihar: Where Culture, Community, and Joy Come Together

Balvihar continues to thrive as a joyful space where children connect deeply with our rich heritage through engaging activities, meaningful stories, and a warm, welcoming community. Every Sunday at 10:30 AM, we begin with an uplifting assembly that includes prayer recitations and bhajan singing, followed by a yoga session led by a passionate youth volunteer.

Each year, our students celebrate Diwali by creating vibrant artwork that adorns the hallways of the Hindu Temple. They also participate in the temple's annual Diwali program, sharing their talents and devotion with the broader community. This year, our students will present a heartfelt performance of the bhajan "*Kabhi Ram Banke, Kabhi Shyam Banke*"—a beautiful expression of divine love and unity.

Artwork By Balvihar Students

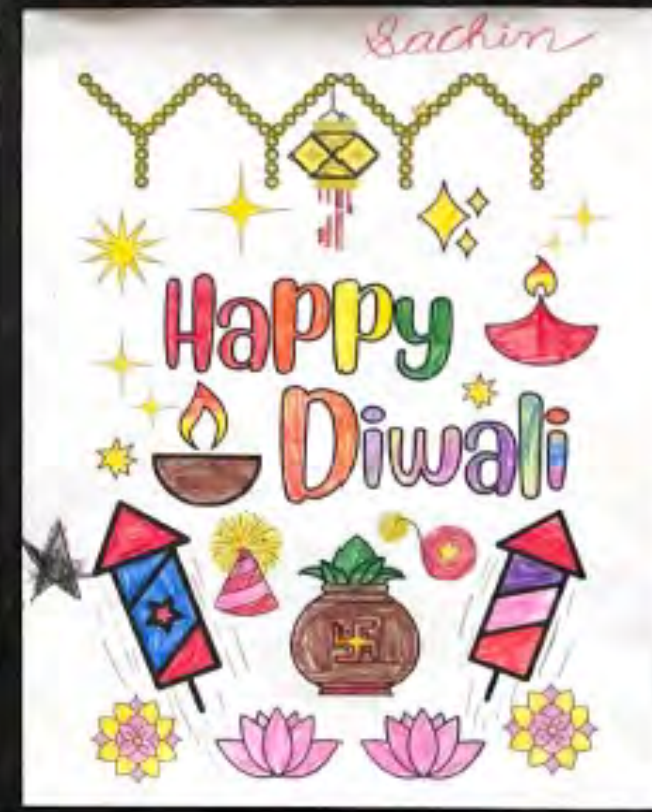
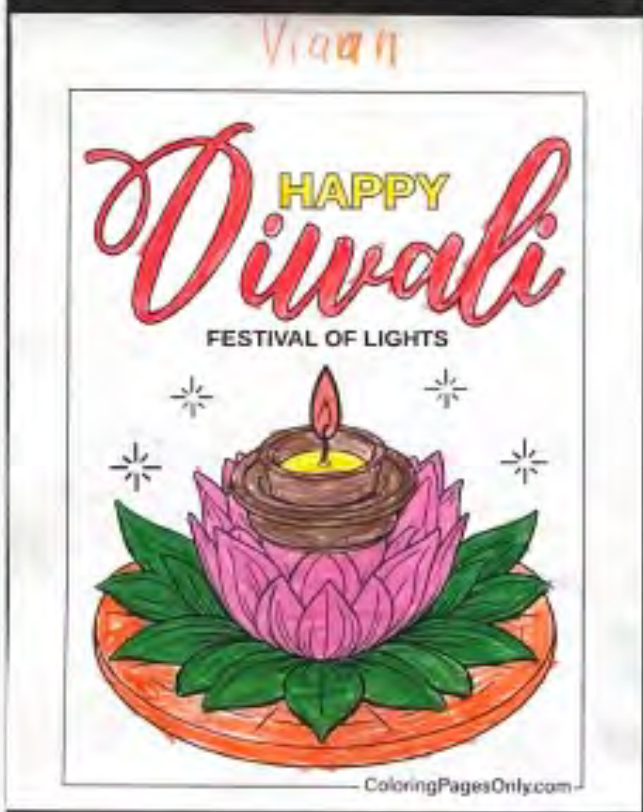
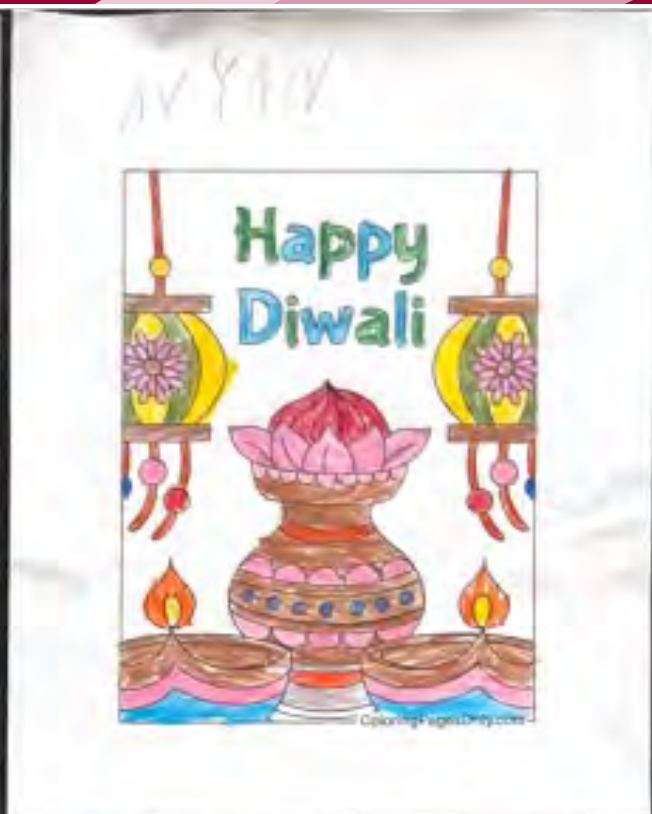


Balvihar would not be possible without our dedicated teachers – Mrs. Purnima Singh, Mrs. Meera Singh, Mrs. Sushmita Pal, Ms. Bharti Jindal, Mrs. Supriya Deshmukh, Mr. Rajesh Sharma, who generously volunteer their time every Sunday despite full-time careers. Their commitment to nurturing the next generation is the heartbeat of our program.

More than a Sunday school, Balvihar is a place where children grow spiritually, culturally, and socially. We invite your family to be part of this enriching journey—where traditions are celebrated, friendships blossom, and learning is filled with joy.

Introducing the Balvihar Library!

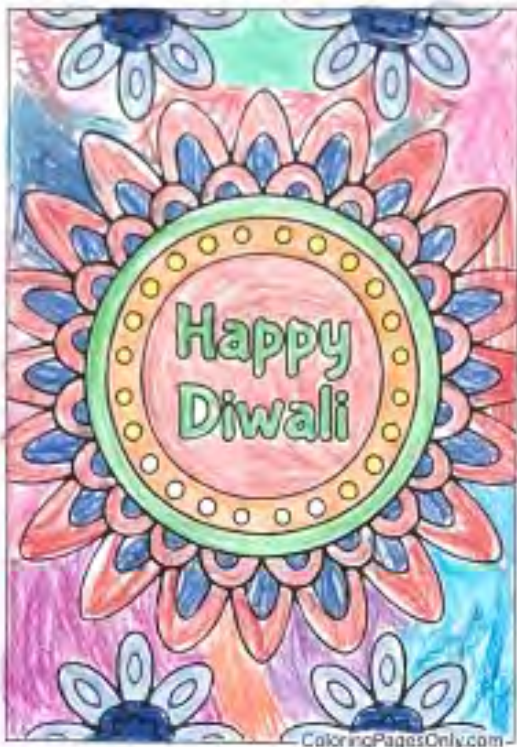
We're launching a **cultural book library**—a treasure trove of Indian stories, moral lessons, and heritage books that students can check out and explore at home. If you have books on Indian culture or moral stories that you'd love to share, we welcome your donations! Please email us at infobalviharomaha@gmail.com to contribute.



Balvihar Activities by Kids

Balvihar Activities and Learning

Siya

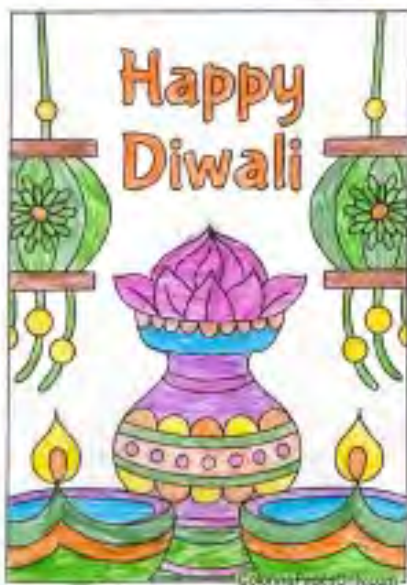


Shanay

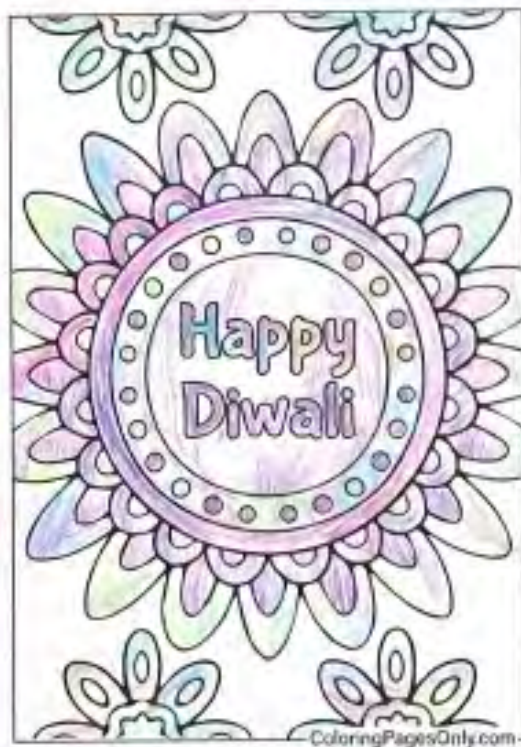


Maq

Maq



Tanish



Bal Vihar: A Historical Journey of Preserving and Teaching Indian Culture to Children

Children born in the United States to Indian immigrant parents often find themselves navigating the complexities of balancing their dual cultural identities. For many, the experience of growing up between two cultures can be challenging, as they try to preserve their Indian heritage while integrating into American society. Recognizing the need for a space where children could connect with their Indian roots, the community came together to establish Bal Vihar.

Founded in 1982–83 by Smt. Nina Mote and Smt. Sadhana Malik, Bal Vihar began as a small, community-driven initiative aimed at introducing children to Indian culture, religion, and traditions. The first classes were held in the home of Smt. Nina Mote and late Dr. Sharad H. Mote, and the program was offered free of charge. The goal was to create a welcoming and educational environment where children could learn about sacred Hindu scriptures, cultural practices, and core Indian values.

As the word spread within the Indian community in Omaha, NE, more parents began bringing their children to Mote's home to learn about sacred texts such as the Ramayana, Mahabharata, and Bhagavad Gita. The growth of both the city and the Indian community were closely intertwined, with more Indian immigrants arriving in Omaha, NE seeking a way to stay connected to their cultural heritage. This demand eventually led to the establishment of the Hindu Temple of Omaha, NE in December 1994, providing a central place of worship and spiritual gathering for the growing community.

In 1994, Bal Vihar moved its classes to the temple's premises, marking a key milestone in its development. This expansion provided a larger space to accommodate the increasing number of students and further deepened the connection between the program and the community. During this time, the first edition of the Bal Vihar Handbook was created, compiling valuable resources on Hindu values, culture, and scriptures. Key contributors to this edition included are-

Dr. Alekha Dash	Smt. Manju Mehta
Dr. Anuja Ghorpade	Smt. Nina Mote
Shri. Anoop Verma	Smt. Padmaja Khot
Dr. Jayashree Paknikar	Dr. Phani Tej Adidam
Smt. Jyoti Chintalapudi	Dr. Shantaram S. Joshi

Organizational Structure and Leadership

Bal Vihar operates under a volunteer-based structure, with a dedicated group of teachers and an Education Coordinator who oversees the direction and growth of the program. The education coordinator's role rotates every two years to ensure fresh leadership, ideas, and innovative

Continued.....

approaches. This leadership rotation encourages dynamic collaboration and helps keep the program evolving.

The program's structure is designed to foster a strong sense of community and continuity. At the end of each academic year, Bal Vihar hosts an Annual Day event, where students are recognized for their achievements and given the opportunity to showcase the knowledge they have gained. This event is a celebration of the students' hard work, and it brings together families to honor the children's progress.

Bal Vihar also benefits from the ongoing support of the Hindu Temple leadership and the larger community. The founding members of Bal Vihar have set an example of dedication, commitment, and service, and their vision is continued to this day by the teachers who volunteer their time and energy to this program.

Curriculum Enhancement and New Initiatives

As Bal Vihar grew, so did the need for a more expansive curriculum. The program continually revised its curriculum to ensure that it was developmentally appropriate for each age group levels, Prathama, Dwitiya, Tritiya and the Youth group. The classes were created to provide knowledge about Hindu Dharma, highlighting its culture and heritage, while actively involving Bal Vihar children in a range of meaningful activities. New initiatives were introduced to further enhance the program, including the introduction of a Bal Vihar logo. The Bal Vihar logo was designed by Smt. Kiran Khajuria, and Dr. Rajesh K. Sharma in May 2009 and was adapted in August 2009. Bal Vihar logo serves as a symbol of the program's mission to preserve and promote Indian culture.

In response to technological advancements, Bal Vihar launched a website to facilitate communication with families and to make information more accessible. The pandemic further accelerated the need for innovation, leading to the introduction of remote learning, which allowed children to continue their education from home. The flexibility of online classes has since become a permanent feature, making it easier for children from other cities to participate. Additionally, Bal Vihar has incorporated digital tools and technologies into its curriculum to create more interactive and engaging lessons for students.

Celebrating Indian Festivals

Indian festivals play a central role in the Bal Vihar experience, providing children with opportunities to engage directly with cultural traditions. Diwali, the Festival of Lights, is one of the most significant festivals celebrated at Bal Vihar, where children learn about its spiritual significance, the symbolism of light over darkness, and the values of kindness and goodwill.

In addition to Diwali, Bal Vihar celebrates several other major Indian festivals, including Holi (the Festival of Colors) and Saraswati Puja (dedicated to the goddess of knowledge and learning).

Continued.....

These festivals offer rich cultural and religious experiences, where children learn about the rituals, customs, and spiritual significance of each celebration.

In addition to participating in Indian Hindu festivals, Bal Vihar kids also participate in Indian patriotic functions hosted by Indian Association on Nebraska (IAN) such as- Independence Day and Republic Day.

Apart from these significant festivals, Bal Vihar also organizes a special Fun Day every other year. This day is dedicated to fostering socialization and teamwork among the children through structured, fun activities. The focus of Fun Day is purely on giving children an opportunity to bond, have fun, and enjoy a day of relaxation, with no curriculum content.

In Conclusion

The success and growth of Bal Vihar is a testament to its strong community foundation and the ongoing commitment of its volunteers. The program's ability to evolve while staying true to its mission of connecting children with their cultural heritage has been instrumental in its continued success.

Bal Vihar recognizes and appreciates the continued support and guidance from the leadership of the Hindu Temple and the broader community. The exemplary modeling of the founding members continues to inspire and guide the program today. The dedicated teachers and volunteers, who selflessly give their time, are key to ensuring that the program thrives, enriching the lives of children and instilling in them a deep sense of pride in their Indian heritage.

As we reflect on the historical journey of Bal Vihar, we take this opportunity to honor the invaluable contributions of the education coordinators and teachers who have played a pivotal role in its growth and success. Their dedication, passion, and commitment to education have been central to the development of Bal Vihar and have profoundly impacted the lives of countless children. Their efforts have not only nurtured young minds but have also instilled a deep sense of pride in our cultural heritage.

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to all those who have been part of this journey, and we offer special recognition to the following education coordinators and teachers, whose leadership and guidance have been instrumental in our success:

Education Coordinators-

Smt. Nina Mote (Founding Member)	Smt. Vandana Singh
Smt. Manju Mehta	Smt. Purnima Singh
Smt. Natasha Keshwani	Shri. Ramakrishana Prasad
Dr. Rajesh K Sharma	

Continued.....

Teachers-

Shri Anil Srinivasan
Smt. Archana Janakiraman
Smt. Arunima Dashgupta
Smt. Ashima Mehta
Shri. Ashok Mirchandani
Km. Bharti Jindal
Dr. Ganesh Naik
Smt. Kiran Khajuria
Smt. Meera Singh
Dr. Monica Arora

Dr. Parvathi Chundi
Smt. Sangeeta Agrawal
Dr. Sanjay Singh
Smt. Sandhya Thamma
Smt. Shaffaly Jain
Smt. Sudha Agrawal
Smt. Supriya Deshmukh
Smt. Susmita Pal
Smt. Swaroop Nijhawan
Smt. Timisha Singh

And many others whose unwavering commitment has served as a guiding light for the children of Bal Vihar. Thanks to their continued efforts, Bal Vihar's legacy will endure, inspiring future generations of children to embrace their cultural heritage and contribute meaningfully to a diverse and interconnected world.

विद्या दान सबसे बड़ा दान है।

(Vidya dan sabse bada dan hai)

Translation: "The gift of knowledge is the greatest gift."

This quote highlights the importance of education, which is central to the mission of Bal Vihar in imparting knowledge about Indian culture and traditions to children. It emphasizes the value of nurturing minds through education, a key aspect of Bal Vihar's work.

Written by Dr. Rajesh K. Sharma – *With gratitude for the opportunity to share this perspective!*



**Happy Deepavali! Wishing You Endless
Health & Wealth!!**

From:

Sayi Kishore Repakula

Madhavi Repakula

Shreya Repakula & Ajay Repakula



**Happy DEEPAVALI and Prosperous
NEW YEAR**

From:

Sundar Chokkara

Geeta Chokkara

Sukarn Chokkara

Sumeet Chokkara



**Wishing a very happy Deepawali and a very happy New Year
2026**



From:

Anil, Kusum, Anuj, Priya, and Arjun Bhalla



From:

Phani Tej Adidam

Kranti Adidam

Keshav Adidam

Ishani Adidam

Hamsini Adidam



Hindu Temple Donations thru Sep 30, 2025

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Guarantor (Over \$50,000)

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Archana & Premkumar Neelakanta	Kanta & Prem Arora	Meera & Mahendra Varman	Sandhya Thamma & Srinivasu Pinapati	Vijay Kashyap & Deepa Hangal
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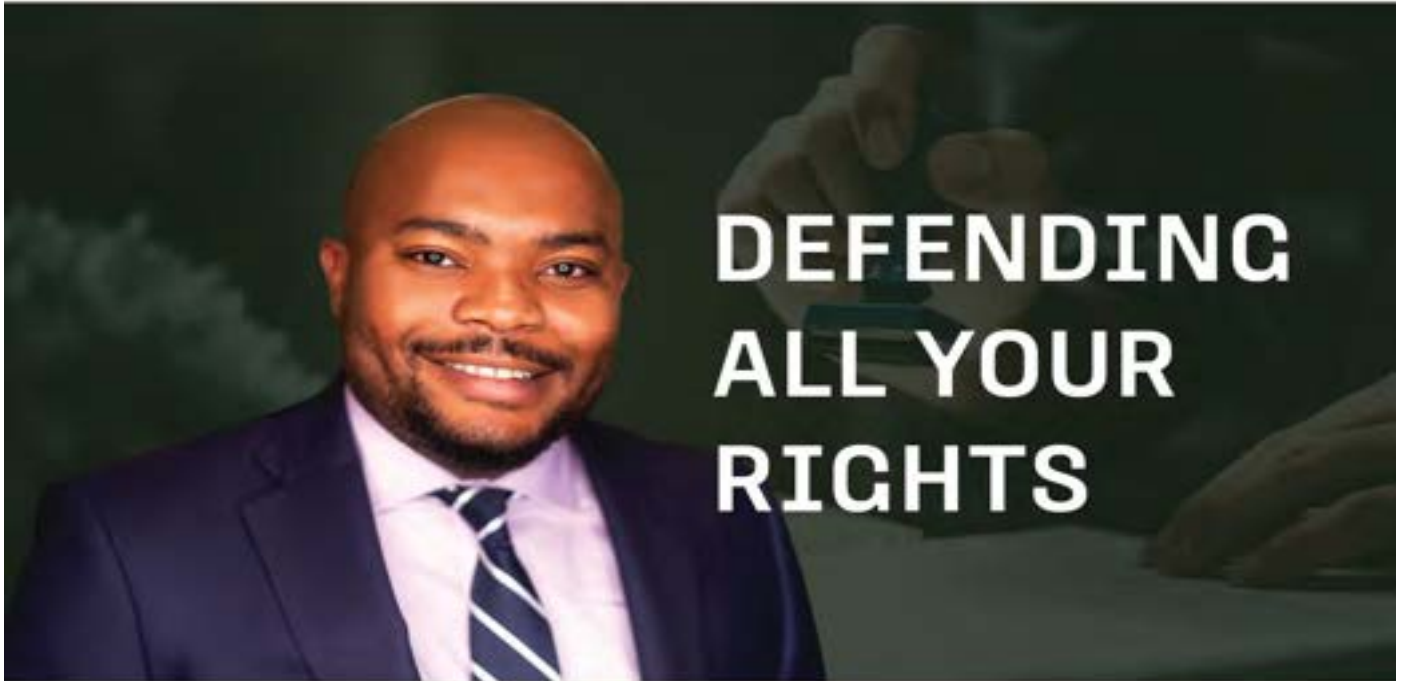


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by Swami Nikhilanand Ji



Swami Nikhilanand Ji was first introduced to Hinduism at the age of 25. Since then, he has spent the last 25 years studying the philosophy of Sanskrit scriptures and practicing under the guidance of Jagadguru Shri Kripalu Ji Maharaj. Now, he resides at the largest Hindu ashram in the U.S., Radha Madhav Dham, Austin, TX.

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Vibhooti Yoga

Jitender Singh Deogun

The concept of Bhakti is not only considered the spiritual core of our religious landscape but also considered the supreme path for the highest spiritual pursuit of a devotee. The Narada Bhakti Sutra declares that

त्रिसत्यस्य भक्तिरेव गरीयसी भक्तिरेव गरीयसी ॥ NBS 81 ॥

“Among the three paths (truths) (Karma, Gyana, and Bhakti Yoga) Bhakti, Devotion, or Divine Love alone is the supreme, indeed Devotion alone is the greatest.”

The philosophical spectrum of Bhakti spans from the theistic dualism of Dvaita (द्वैतः) to absolute monism of Advaita (अद्वैतः). This represents a continuum of devotional love; from an emotional perspective of Bhakti—Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, on one end to a contemplative perspective of Bhakti—Adi Shankaracharya, on the other end. Scriptures, however, teach us that all spiritual activities ultimately (should) lead to Bhakti.

The Vibhooti yoga, Chapter 10 of Srimad Bhagwat Gita, is probably the simplest path leading to Devotional Love. In Sanskrit, Vibhooti means manifestation, glory or splendor. Vibhooti yoga describes the Lordship of Bhagwan Sri Krishna and Immanence of the Self, the Purusha. One can realize the eternal bliss by realizing His Glory and Splendor in His manifestations. We must comprehend the entire discourse for a deep understanding of Vibhooti yoga but Shlokas 1-5, 10 do present a good perspective and motivation for this chapter and for Vibhooti Yoga.

श्रीभगवानुवाच —

भूय एव महाबाहो शृणु मे परमं वचः ।

यत्तेऽहं प्रीयमाणाय वक्ष्यामि हितकाम्यया ॥ १०-१॥

Shloka 1. O mighty armed, listen to My Supreme words; wishing your welfare, I will tell you, I know you are delighted to hear me.

Bhagwan Sri Krishna not only wants Arjuna to win the war but also wants him to be able to win the kingdom of eternal bliss which is the real heritage of us all and the Lord is thus happy to

continue His discourse. In Shloka 2, Bhagwan Sri Krishna emphasizes that to get *Brahma-Vidya*, you must learn by yourself, by direct experience.

न मे विदुः सुगुणाः प्रभवन् न महर्षयः ।

अहमादिर्हि देवानां महर्षीणां च सर्वशः ॥ १०-२॥

Shloka 2. Neither the hosts of heaven (सुगुणाः) nor great Rishis know My origin; for, in every way, I am the source of all Devas and the Rishis.

For *Brahma-Vidya*, the indirect method of learning is not available, because, as the Lord Sri Krishna says, neither the hosts of heavens nor the seers know His origin. First, by the great seers He does not mean the men-of-wisdom, in our mythology but the Seven Rishis (सप्त ऋषीः). To put the concept of Seven Seers in perspective, we should understand the following two principles. The Consciousness Principle: अहं ब्रह्मास्मि that is the Self is Purusha—the Pure Consciousness, and The Cosmic-Principle: महत् Mahat, or Buddhi is the Cosmic-Intellect or Universal Mind. It's the source of all intellectual faculties and facilitates all interactions between Purusha and Prakriti. The Seven Seers in the Shloka 2 are The Mahat, Ego (Ahamkara), and the five Tanmatras—sense organs (eyes, ears, tongue, nose and skin) personified in the Puranas under different names.

Still, we, the mortals can realize the Self, as Bhagwan Sri Krishna says in next Shloka:

यो मामजमनादि च वेत्ति लोकमहेश्वरम् ।

असम्मूढः स मर्त्येषु सर्वपापैः प्रमुच्यते ॥ १०-३॥

Shloka 3. Among the mortals, who knows Me as unborn and beginningless, the great Lord of the worlds, is undeluded and liberated from all sins. This is one of the core Shlokas of this chapter. In this Shloka Bhagwan Sri Krishna is addressing us, the mortals. He says that even the Devas and the Rishis do not know Him (Shloka 2) and cannot know Him (Shloka 3) but the mortals can know Him and be liberated by knowing Him. Shloka 3 confirms Mandukya Upanishad (3.2.9) that one who knows Brahman becomes Brahman.

Continued.....

स यो ह वै तत्परमं ब्रह्म वेद भवति ब्रह्मैव भवति ॥ 3.2.9 ॥

Adi Sankaracharya says:

ब्रह्म सत्यः जगत् मिथ्या जीवो ब्रह्मो नपरः

The Brahman is the Truth, the world is illusory, Brahman is the only singular reality. The Atman is not separate from Brahman.

However, "He who Knows Me" does not mean just knowing in the everyday sense, it is not an intellectual comprehension, it's not even an intellectual or emotional pursuit. It is a religious journey; it is a takeoff on a Spiritual flight.

To understand the meaning of this Shloka, we see that the Cosmic Principle, the Essence, the Supreme Self cannot have a beginning, and thus in Shloka 3, Self is Unborn and Beginningless. However, the meaning of लोकमहेश्वरः, implying सर्वलोकमहेश्वरः Sarva-loka-maheshwarah, Lord of all the Worlds is not that straightforward. First, the word Loka-लोकः is derived from a root that means "to experience"; thus, Loka is a field of experiences and सर्वलोकः -Sarvaloka means all fields/worlds of experiences, including physical, mental, behavioral and spiritual. Thus, the Shloka says: we must realize the Lordship of Bhagwan Sri Krishna over all the worlds of experiences that one enjoys partaking in at all the dimensions of mind, body, and intellect. No one achieves Self-realization without this knowledge—the Brahman Gyan, a direct inner experience, or the realization of Lord Sri Krishna, the Great Lord of all the worlds—the transcendental One. The Shloka 3 continues that one among the mortals who knows Him is undeluded and is liberated from all the sins, committed knowingly or unknowingly. Thus, the essence of Vibhooti yoga is that we can realize the eternal bliss by realizing Bhagwan Sri Krishna in all His Splendor and all the Glories in His manifestations.

In Shlokas 4 and 5, Lord Sri Krishna, enumerates various virtues—Positive qualities and vices—negative qualities. All these qualities are part of the existence of the man. These Shlokas also emphasize that in our Dharma there is no concept of devil to sway us away from Sri Bhagwan. The Bhagwan Sri Krishna alone is the material and efficient cause of all our worlds of experiences.

बुद्धिर्ज्ञानमसम्मोहः क्षमा सत्यं दमः शमः ।

सुखं दुःखं भवोऽभावः भयं चाभयमेव च ॥ १०-४॥

अहिंसा समता तुष्टिः तपो दानं यशोऽयशः ।

भवन्ति भावा भूतानां मत्त एव पृथग्विधाः ॥ १०-५॥

Shloka 4. Intellect, wisdom, non-delusion, forgiveness, truth, restraint, calmness, happiness, pain, birth or death, fear, and fearlessness, . . .

Shloka 5. Non-injury, equanimity, contentment, austerity, beneficence, fame, infamy, all these different qualities-of-beings arise from Me alone.

The consciousness we have is very subjective—Truth in us, The Truth is tainted by our "ego" that hides the Supreme Truth from us. When the ego vanishes, one comes to know the real meaning of "He who Knows Me," and realizes the Lordship of Sri Bhagwan Krishna, सर्वलोकमहेश्वरः (Sarvaloka-maheshwarah)—The Lord of all the Worlds. The effulgence of the Supreme—Self dispels the darkness of ignorance and Self-realization happens spontaneously.

Understanding and conquering ego with steadfast devotion is the key to Self-realization. Even an insignificant Karma or emotion, not devoted to Bhagwan Sri Krishna, is a manifestation of ego. In the Chapter 10 discourse, Sri Bhagwan says He resides in the hearts of His devotees because of compassion for them and destroys the darkness of ignorance with the effulgence of the Supreme knowledge. Shloka 10 states that the devotees who are completely tuned to Him with devotional love are blessed to attain Self-realization.

तेषां सततयुक्तानां भजतां प्रीतिपूर्वकम् ।

ददामि बुद्धियोगं तं येन मामुपयान्ति ते ॥ १०-१०॥

Shloka 10: To them who always worship me with unwavering devotional love, I grant them wisdom by which they can reach Me.

In this discourse, Sri Bhagwan makes it clear that those devotees who engage in contemplation on Him with true devotional love, He is kind to them to grant them the wisdom of discrimination—the enlightenment to know His real nature, and thus the full understanding of "He who Knows Me." .

Acknowledgements: In addition to study of Hindu and Sikh Scriptures, the author benefited greatly from reading books by Swami Chinmayananda, Swami Yatiswarananda, and others.

Local Eagle Scout Leads Effort to Plant 7 Maple trees at Hindu Temple of Nebraska

Pavan Sai Athota is a senior in Millard North Highschool and an Eagle Scout serving Troop 492 in Omaha is able to lead and manage to plant 7 maple trees around iron fence in the temple premises.

He addressed a need in the community, such as replacing dead trees, covering empty space in between existing trees and increasing green space in and around temple.

This Eagle project will help the Hindu Temple to improve local environment by increasing tree cover and promoting biodiversity and also helps to improve air quality, reducing soil erosion and providing shady area for outdoor activity.

This Eagle project is planned, executed (07/28/2025) with the help of Scout leaders, Scouts and temple volunteers who all spent 150 hours together. This project is costed around \$800 funded by Scout parents.





Durga Puja 2025 by Bengali Samiti of Nebraska



HAPPY DEEPAVALI FROM THE :
VISWA NATYA NIKETAN SCHOOL OF BHARATANATYAM
AND KUCHIPUDI, OMAHA NEBRASKA . VISWANATYA@GMAIL.COM
&
Shrimati Ushasree and Shriman Sushant Devaraju
Dr. Pranita Devaraju, M.D., and Ms Niharika Devaraju





Ganesh Chaturthi Celebration- 2025



Happy Deepavali and Prosperous New Year

From:

SAWHNEY FAMILY

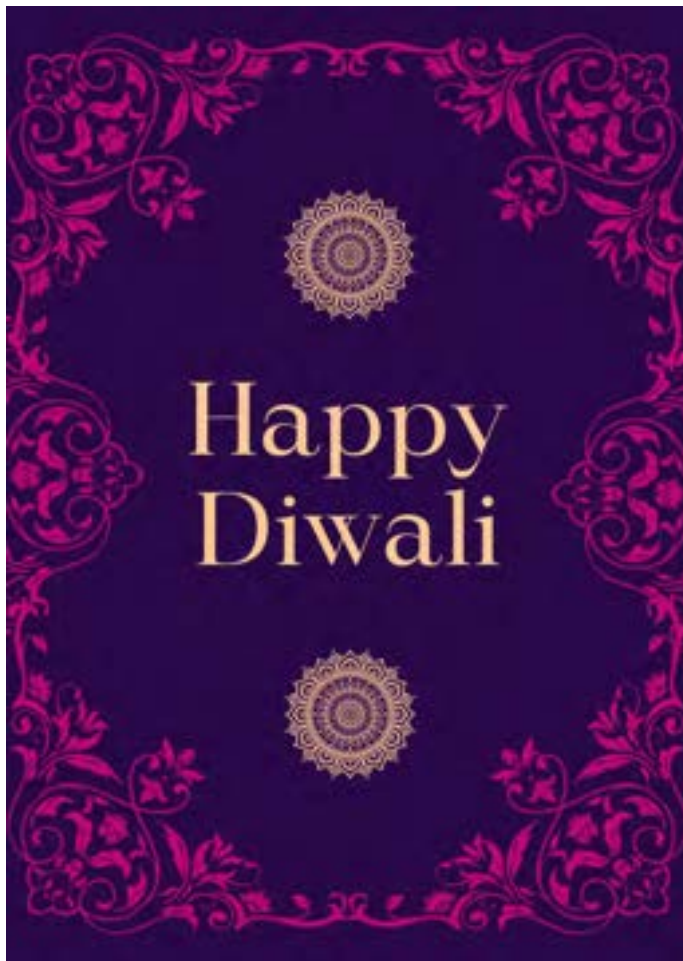
**Harish and Shobha,
Angeli, Akash, Aria & Ayaan
Meghna and Amit**



Happy Deepavali Wishes

From:

**Dr. Rajeswar Rao
Lakshmi Rao
Kishore Rao, Dr. Smriti,
Dr. Prashant, Savitha, and
Krithika**



Best Wishes and
Happy Diwali

From:

**Smita and Alekha
Dash**

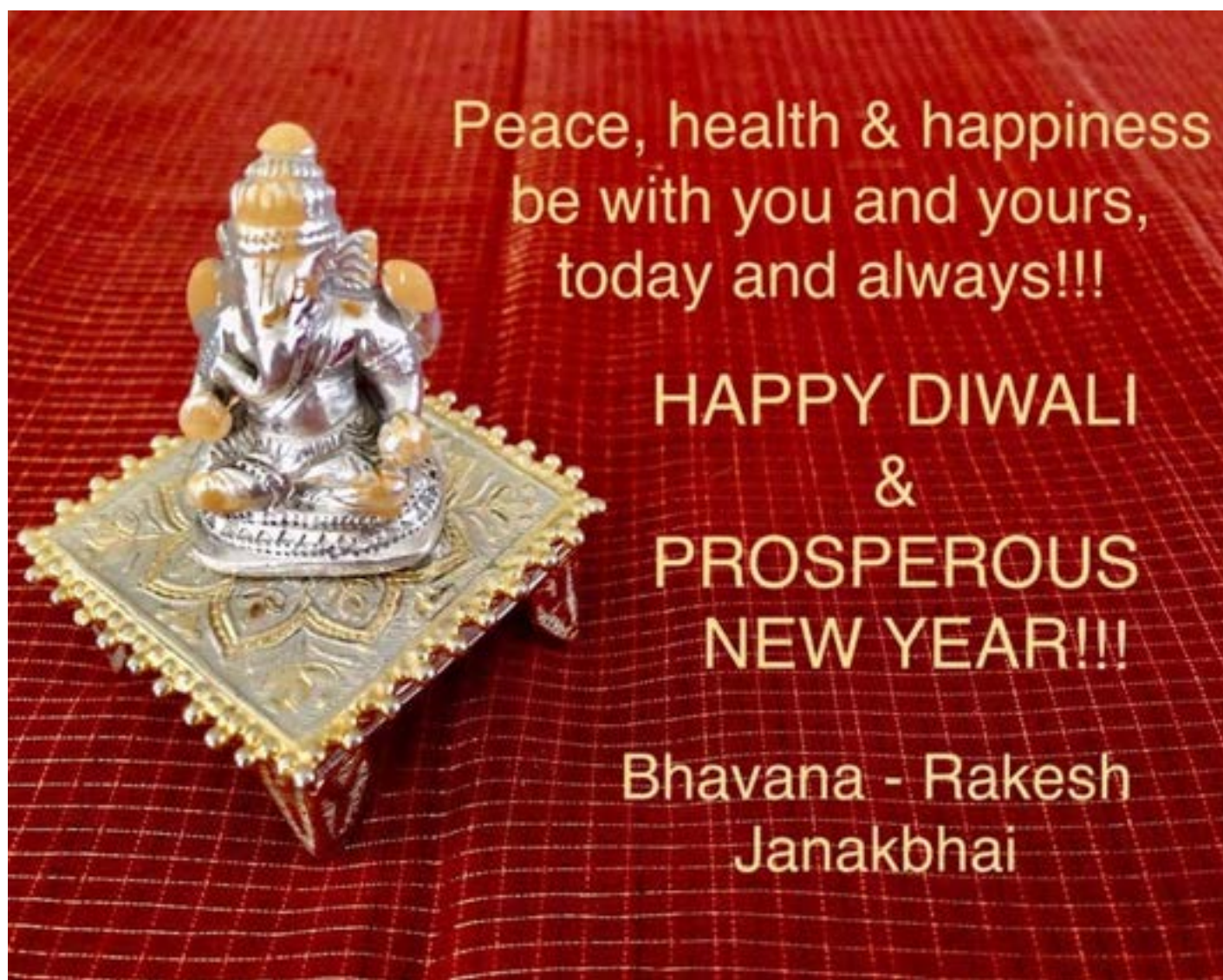
Rohan Dash

**Debleena, Ajay,
Sarika & Sahil
Saini**





Mahashivratri Puja - 2025



Peace, health & happiness
be with you and yours,
today and always!!!

HAPPY DIWALI
&
PROSPEROUS
NEW YEAR!!!

Bhavana - Rakesh
Janakbhai





Happy Deepavali Wishes

From:

Saraswathi G. Joshi & Family
Sumangala and Shantaram Joshi
Deepa, Nikhil and Juhi Kumar
And Kiran Kumar
Yashaswini K. Joshi & Family



Wishing You All
A Very Happy
Deepavali

From:

Jitender and Ravinder Deogun

Please Join Us in Saying “Thank You” to Our Priests and Facility Manager



Pandit Nagabhat Vidyashankar
Priest, Hindu Temple



Pandit Badari Narayana
Priest, Hindu Temple



Pandit Laxmikant Kulkarni
Priest, Hindu Temple



Pandit Jagannatha Bhaktavatsala
Priest, Hindu Temple



Shri Chandrasekhar Karmegam
Facility Manager, Hindu Temple

Editor's Corner

"It is my great pleasure to bring the 2025 Deepavali special issue of Deepam to you all. We have included the useful updates and details of the major events such as Deepavali Puja, messages from our leaders, Deepavali greetings from our community members, a brief reports on Balvihar activities and upcoming major events/pujas of 2025. We thank all the devotees for their continued support of Deepam.

In this special issue, we have included an updated donors list as of September 30, 2025, including donors who have donated over \$3,000 donation to the temple since its inception. We sincerely thank all the donors for their generous contribution. If there is any error in the amount we have listed, please contact Shri Venkatesh Bettadapura or Shri Sundar Khandavalli. Please help temple to grow by giving your precious time, effort, constructive criticism and generous donation.

We also want to thank all the advertisers for their support of this publication. We invite you all to consider contributing articles for publication in the quarterly Deepam issues. Articles from young adults are also welcome and I request the parents to encourage their children to contribute their articles. I look forward to your suggestions to improve the Deepam.

I also take this opportunity to thank the members of Publication Advisory Committee for their help in bringing this special issue. We also want to thank the Printing Facility, Creighton University for this publication.

Wishing you all a **"Very Happy Deepavali and Prosperous New Year 2026"**

Nagendra Chaturvedi, Editor

on behalf of Publication Committee

Hindu Temple



The Bhatia family wishes all the patron families of Hindu Temple a very happy and blessed Diwali and best wishes for the happy New Year ahead.

Drs. Shashi and Subhash Bhatia

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HAPPY DEEPAVALI

Classical Dance Activities at Hindu Temple





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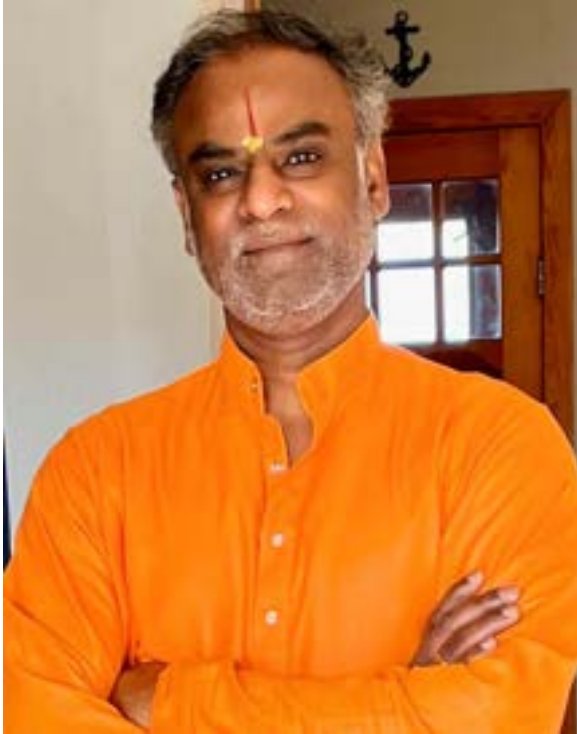
**Shri Subhas Subramani and
Shrimati Sarathi Subhas**



Ms. Meena Sanjay

Thank You Outstanding Cafeteria Volunteers. You have been consistently supporting for last 3 years to help in the success of our cafeteria.

2025 Outstanding Volunteers of Hindu Temple, Omaha



Shri Sanjeevi Raja Mariappan



Shrimati Aditi Vinod Gouroji



Mr. Surya Venkatesh

THANK YOU
volunteers for your
dedication and
commitment for last
several years

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**Happy Deepavali to You All
From Hindu Temple, Omaha NE**

